School of Computing and Creative Technologies

Assessment Brief

Submission details

Module title:	Software Development Project
Module code:	UFCFFF-30-3
Module Leader:	Steve Battle
Assessment title:	Project report
Year:	2026-27
Assessment type:	report
Assessment weighting:	50% of total module mark
Size or length of assessment:	6000-word report
Module learning outcomes assessed by this task:	**MO1** Work on a real-life problem, synthesising and critically evaluating information from multiple sources including academic and commercial documents. **MO2** Follow a development lifecycle from an initial idea through to the realisation of a software artefact using appropriate tools and methodologies.
Use of AI in assessment:	**Generative Artificial intelligence (Gen AI) tools can be used in an assistive role** You are permitted to use Gen AI tools in an assistive role in this assessment to support you with: • drafting and structuring content • supporting a particular process such as translating content • providing ideas or inspiration to help you overcome a creative block. While GenAI tools might suggest topics/content, you will always need to go back and locate and critically engage with actual literature/research/evidence yourself. As the use of Gen AI is optional (due to its purely supportive capacity) its use is not part of the skills or knowledge you need to demonstrate for this assessment. However, if you have used Gen AI to prepare or produce part or all your work, you must acknowledge its use. For more advice on this (and its use in general) please see your Generative AI study skills guide.
Guidance on Referencing (inc. AI):	Please note that the aim of referencing is to demonstrate you have read and understood a range of sources to evidence your key points. You need to list the references consistently and in such a way as to ensure the reader can follow up on the sources for themselves. Use Cite Them Right Harvard referencing for both citations and references. All references must be cited. Referencing - Study skills | UWE Bristol Using generative AI at UWE Bristol - Study skills | UWE Bristol

Submission and feedback dates

Submission deadline:	Before 14:00 on May 06, 2027 Is eligible for 48-hour late submission window All times are 24-hour clock, current local time (at time of submission) in the UK.
Submission format:	Word (docx). A report outline is provided with suggested headings.
Marks and Feedback due on:	03/06/27
Marks and Feedback will be provided via:	Please share an early draft of your project report with your supervisor, and they will provide you with formative feedback to help you improve your work. Summative feedback is provided after the submission due date.

Completing your assessment

What am I required to do on this assessment?
The project is an **individual** piece of work, exploring an idea from conception through to realisation. The topic of the project should be agreed with your supervisor. Suitable topics may stem from staff, the student, the student's employer or other outside organisations. The topic must lend itself to research followed by a software development process based on the research.

The research component will include the identification of a suitable topic and subsequent **secondary research** using books, papers and other sources. Software development will include the identification of suitable tools and methodologies to use, giving full and careful attention to the issues of quality and risk.

There is an expectation that you will carry out **primary research** which may be a survey, requirements capture, design feedback, or user evaluation. Alternatively, your primary research may be purely technical, based on experiments, performance testing, technical evaluation or analysis. Either way, you are expected to carry out your research in accordance with UWE's ethical governance process, so you must submit an **ethical checklist** for approval before collecting data (see templates provided).

You will be expected to demonstrate that you understand the importance of **version control** (e.g. GitHub) as it applies to software and systems; have defined suitable configuration management processes for use throughout the product development lifecycle in storing software deliverables and controlling and tracking changes to your software; have used configuration management and version control tools and release management frameworks and applied sound change management processes properly and effectively when modifying your software designs and deliverables.

Whatever the subject you will be expected to treat material critically and to demonstrate your understanding of the relevance of the material both to your award to the project topic. You will also be expected to reflect on the tools and methodologies used and, at the project completion, comment on their suitability.

If you have any questions about this assignment, please contact the module leader.

Where should I start?
You will be assigned a supervisor who will meet with you to discuss progress your project brief.

What do I need to do to pass?
Choose a project idea that is fun, suitably stretching, but not over-ambitious. The pass mark is 40%.

How do I achieve high marks in this assessment?
You must derive a clear and relevant set of requirements from research, ultimately captured as a well-defined set of use-cases. Your analysis will include a clear exposition of the available technology options and the risks involved. From this you will develop your Software Requirements Specification. You will be following a well-defined defined methodology, developing a thoroughly tested information system with clear traceability back to the requirements. You will provide good evidence of version control and configuration management. Your write-up will include insightful and critical reflection on the development process, including lessons learned. You will use UML diagrams used where necessary, and Cite Them Right Harvard referencing must be used throughout. Explain things in your own words, not those of a machine.

How does the learning and teaching relate to the assessment?
Guidance about the project development process is covered in a short lecture series at the start of the academic year covering topics such as Choosing a project and researching the project idea, moving from research to requirements, configuration and release management and version control, quality planning and assurance, and writing up the project.

What additional resources may help me complete this assessment?
You will find relevant references in the module's reading list.

What do I do if I am concerned about completing this assessment?
It is recommended that you review all the relevant materials on Blackboard. You can also speak to your module leader for advice and guidance. UWE Bristol offer a range of Assessment Support Options that you can explore through this link, and both Student Support Advisers and Wellbeing Support are available. For further information, please see the Student study essentials.

How do I avoid an Assessment Offence on this module?
Use the support above if you feel unable to submit your own work for this module. It is important to ensure that you have ethical approval for any primary research you do that involves others. Include evidence of approval in the appendices of your project report. Lack of ethical approval will be treated as an Assessment Offence. Avoid collusion and plagiarism – copying work from others or from the internet.

Marks and Feedback

1. In line with UWE Bristol's Assessment Content Limit Policy (formerly the Word Count Policy), word count includes all text, including (but not limited to): the main body of text (including headings), all citations (both in and out of brackets), text boxes, tables and graphs, figures and diagrams, quotes, lists.
2. UWE Bristol's Academic Conduct Policy and Academic Misconduct Procedures (Assessment Offence Policy) is available from the Academic Integrity webpages and requires that you submit work that is entirely your own and reflects your own learning, so it is important to:
    - Ensure you reference all sources and use Cite Them Right Harvard referencing. See the guidance available on UWE's Study Skills referencing pages.
    - Refer to peer reviewed primary sources, rather than using AI or secondary sources
    - Avoid copying and pasting any work into this assessment, including your own previous assessments, work from other students or internet sources
    - Develop your own style, arguments and wording, so avoid copying sources and changing individual words but keeping, essentially, the same sentences and/or structures from other sources
    - Never give your work to others who may copy it
    - Prepare and develop your own work and review any amends to your work by automatic proof-readers and editors.

When submitting your work, you will be required to confirm that the work is your own, and text-matching software and other methods are routinely used to check submissions against other submissions to the university and internet sources. Details of what constitutes plagiarism and how to avoid it can be found on UWE's Study Skills pages about avoiding plagiarism.

Your assessment will be marked according to the marking criteria on the next page.
You can use these to evaluate your own work before you submit.

Marking Criteria

	< 40%	40% – 50%	50% - 60%	60% - 70%	≧ 70%
Criteria	**Needs Work**	**Pass**	**Good**	**Merit**	**Distinction**
Research and requirements (40%) Relates to MO1	Poorly researched with little or no evidence of references to academic or commercial publications. Functional requirements presented with little or no justification.	Solid primary research with references, but weak on critical evaluation. Clear set of functional requirements, with use-cases but scant evidence of user scenarios driving the whole shebang.	Research draws on a range of relevant academic and industry sources, with evidence of primary research or stakeholder engagement. Functional and non-functional requirements are clearly identified. User scenarios and use cases are provided and show a clear link to the solution. Project scope is defined with key inclusions and exclusions identified.	Well thought-out list of risks and benefits. Defines what is included in the scope of the project. Lists the channels of communication the project will be using, what they will be used for and who the intended audience will be. Research includes primary research which could be a survey, requirements capture, design feedback, or user evaluation.	Demonstrates understanding of the relevance of the source material. Synthesising and critically evaluating information from multiple sources. Clear set of requirements derived from research. Good user scenarios and well-defined use-cases identified and used to derive functional requirements systematically.
Methodology and development (20%) Relates to MO2	Little or no attempt	Weak or poorly justified methodology. No appreciation of the choices available, diving straight into a 'solution'.	A suitable development methodology is selected and justified. Relevant tools, techniques, and development practices are identified and applied throughout development.	Reasonable methodological approach with specific good practices identified, but lacking end-to-end traceability. Version controlled. Good narrative description of the technology choices available but without any kind of analysis.	Good set of relevant research and development methodology tools and techniques identified, and evidence of adherence to them. Documentary evidence of design and implementation. Thorough testing with traceability back to requirements. Good evidence of version control and configuration management throughout development.
Realisation of your ideas. (40%) Relates to MO2	Little or no attempt	The ideas have not been clearly explained. Some detail about your solution, but largely a tick-box exercise.	Tells a good story but lacking sufficient relevant (UML) diagrams. The proposed solution is clearly explained and supported by appropriate technical documentation. The artefact demonstrates successful implementation of the core project requirements.	Technology choices are explained and supported by comparison with alternative approaches, though the analysis may be limited. Good traceability between requirements, code, and testing outcomes. Testing is systematic but may not be comprehensive.	Clear elucidation of an idea in a way that is meaningful to other students and academics. Communicates both the nature of the artefact developed and the process by which it was produced. UML diagrams used where necessary. Cite them right Harvard referencing used throughout.